

BE012O1R field packet

Rifle - Trappers Lake - optional Chapman

Prepared September 26, 2026

LEGALITY-FIRST POSTURE

Legality first. The mapped rule screen, current ownership, posted closures, and a safe backstop are go/no-go items. The 0.25- and 0.5-mile rings are optional planning context, not legal setbacks.

HUNT
BE012O1R
Black bear - either sex

SEASON
September 2-30, 2026
One-half hour before sunrise through one-half hour after sunset. Use the CPW/NOAA time for the exact location.

UNITS
12, 13, 23, 24, 25, 26, 33, 131, 231
Limited rifle and associated methods



01 Run of trip

Two nights at West Rifle Creek, then the Meeker loop.

SAT 26**Rifle charge, zero, then settle in**

Charge at Rifle, drive to West Rifle Creek SWA, use the designated range before sunset, occupy the signed SWA campground, and scout a Rifle corridor if daylight remains.

Sleep: West Rifle Creek SWA campground - night 1 of 2

Legal hinge: The range is closed sunset to sunrise. Camping is lawful here for a licensed hunter during this active big-game season.

SUN 27**Full Rifle hunt day**

Hunt the Rifle cluster at first and last light. Start with H01B for the strongest all-federal map signal; use H01D as the shorter secondary scout.

Sleep: West Rifle Creek SWA campground - night 2 of 2

Legal hinge: Do not treat Rifle Falls State Park or a developed campground as a shooting area. Confirm the occupied point is on huntable land.

MON 28**Top off in Rifle, loop through Meeker**

Return to the Rifle Supercharger and leave near the charge level selected in the car for the remote loop. Take CO 13 to Meeker, then CR 8 and FR 205 to Trappers Lake. Scout or hunt H02A or H02D.

Sleep: Shepherds Rim if signed open/available; otherwise a posted-legal established dispersed site below the lake complex

Legal hinge: Horse Thief is stock-users-only. Trappers Lake wilderness camping exclusions still apply even when a pullout looks established.

TUE 29**Dawn at Trappers; Chapman is optional**

Hunt Trappers at first light. Add Chapman only if time, charge, and the signed road status support it; otherwise exit toward the Kremmling Supercharger. At Chapman, start with H03C or H03A.

Sleep: Return Tuesday; if extending, use the signed Chapman campground or a legal FR 940 dispersed site

Legal hinge: The Tesla decides road suitability in the field. The packet does not impose a weather-based closure that the land manager has not imposed.



Hard legal rules

The governing requirements; optional caution margins are not promoted to law.

LICENSE / PLACE	Carry the valid BE012O1R license and hunt only its listed GMUs. A hunting license satisfies West Rifle Creek SWA access during the season. FIELD: Keep the license and photo ID on you; keep the offline GMU/ownership layers available.
HOURS / ORANGE	Legal big-game hours are one-half hour before sunrise through one-half hour after sunset. A firearm bear hunter needs 500 square inches of solid fluorescent orange or pink above the waist plus a visible-from-all-directions hat. FIELD: Set daily alarms from the exact-location sunrise/sunset and wear compliant solid color.
SHOT LOCATION	On National Forest land, do not discharge within 150 yards of a residence, building, campsite, developed recreation site, or occupied area, or across/in a manner exposing a person or property. Colorado also prohibits firing from, on, or across a public road; firearm/bow shooters must be at least 50 feet from the road centerline. FIELD: Use the red rule screen as the initial map filter, then confirm the real facility edge, road, ownership, target, and backstop on site.
BAIT	It is illegal to hunt big game over bait regardless of who placed it. Food, refuse, animal parts, salt, minerals, grain, and food-scent products cannot be put out as an attraction. FIELD: Store camp food; never place or expose it to influence bear movement, and do not make the camp/vehicle the shot focus.
FOOD STORAGE	On White River National Forest from May 15 through October 1, unattended attractants must use an allowed method. A closed, locked hard-sided vehicle is expressly allowed; so is an IGBC-certified bear-resistant container. The cited order does not prescribe a tent-to-vehicle distance. FIELD: Put food, trash, toiletries, cooking residue, and scented gear in the locked Tesla with all openings closed, or use an approved locker/canister.
DEFENSE OF PROPERTY	Colorado allows wildlife to be killed only when necessary to prevent death, damage, or injury to human life, livestock, real property, or a motor vehicle. Any wildlife killed remains state property and must be reported to CPW within five days. FIELD: A bear merely approaching or investigating is not automatically the necessity finding. Avoid, deter, document, and call CPW; use force only when the statutory necessity actually exists.
AFTER A KILL	Immediately sign, date, detach, and attach the carcass tag. Leave evidence of sex naturally attached; recover the edible meat. Personally present the unfrozen head and hide to CPW within five working days for report, seal, and tooth extraction. FIELD: Mark the kill GPS coordinate and GMU, preserve the head/hide unfrozen, and call the nearest CPW office during business hours.

FAST GO / NO-GO

- GO: valid unit and season; public/huntatable parcel; no closure; outside the actual discharge exclusion; safe target and backstop; legal road position; legal hours.
- NO-GO: private/unknown land without permission; posted closure; developed/occupied-area discharge zone; road violation; bait relationship; cub/family group; unsafe backstop.
- FIELD JUDGMENT: clearance, mud, rut depth, center crown, weather, fire choice, optional caution-ring separation, and whether current sign justifies spending time.



Camp and charge cards

Legal eligibility first; road judgment stays with the driver in the field.

PRIMARY - TWO NIGHTS

West Rifle Creek SWA campground

PLACE: Campground on CR 252, four miles northwest of Hwy 325; follow CPW signs

AUTHORITY: Camping is limited to licensed hunters during an established big-game season and the three days before/after. Fires only in a containment structure.

FOOD: Use the locked Tesla for attractants when unattended; leave the tent free of food and cooking residue.

This is the range/camp stop. It is not Rifle Falls State Park.

TRAPPERS DEVELOPED FALLBACK

Shepherds Rim Campground

PLACE: 39.994722, -107.242778 - CR 8 to FR 205 south

AUTHORITY: Use only a signed open and available site. The listing provides bear lockers at each site.

FOOD: Use the provided locker or the locked vehicle whenever attractants are unattended.

The campground overlaps the modeled food-source footprint, but that is a hunting-quality issue, not a camping prohibition.

TRAPPERS PREFERRED BASE IF LEGAL ON SITE

Lower FR 205 / CR 8 dispersed

PLACE: Use a previously occupied pullout below the developed complex only after checking the current MVUM, signs, and land ownership

AUTHORITY: Inside Flat Tops Wilderness, camping is prohibited within 100 feet of water, a system trail, or restoration/no-camping signs, and within one-quarter mile of Trappers Lake. Vehicle camping must also stay on an open motor route.

FOOD: Locked hard-sided vehicle is an allowed White River food-storage method through October 1.

Previously disturbed ground is evidence of use, not by itself legal authority.

INELIGIBLE

Horse Thief Campground

PLACE: Trappers Lake complex

AUTHORITY: All seven sites are set aside for stock users only.

FOOD: Bear boxes are provided, but that does not change site eligibility.

Do not use for this non-stock trip.

OPTIONAL TUESDAY

Chapman Reservoir / FR 940

PLACE: 40.186666, -107.086231 - Forest Road 940 near Dunckley Pass

AUTHORITY: The developed campground is the clean legal fallback when signed open. Dispersed sites require an open motor route, public land, and no posted closure.

FOOD: Use the locked vehicle or any provided approved storage for all unattended attractants.

The official facility description calls the main approach gravel 2WD; the final occupied site still controls.

CHARGE

Rifle Supercharger

675 Wapiti Ct, Rifle, CO 81650

12 stalls, up to 250 kW, 24/7. Use before West Rifle and again before the Meeker/Trappers loop.

CHARGE

Kremmling Supercharger

605 Park Avenue, Kremmling, CO 80459

8 stalls, up to 250 kW, 24/7. Use as the eastern exit checkpoint.



Scout cards

Rule-screen starts; these are map anchors, not automatic shooting positions.

Confirm public access, the true facility and road boundary, current signs, legal hours, target identity, and a safe backstop before occupying or shooting from any point.

Rifle cluster - GMU 33

Base: West Rifle Creek SWA

H01B / Big Parker Creek 39.696427, -107.740100 2.24 mi from source footprint 2.90 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 63	H01D / West Elk Reservoir 39.676758, -107.665527 1.32 mi from source footprint 1.48 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 59
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Trappers Lake cluster - GMU 24

Base: Shepherds Rim or legal lower-road dispersed site

H02A / Lake of the Woods 40.022751, -107.248367 1.87 mi from source footprint 1.89 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 60	H02D / Fraser Creek 39.974245, -107.242739 1.19 mi from source footprint 1.14 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 57
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Chapman Reservoir cluster - GMU 231

Base: Chapman campground or verified FR 940 dispersed site

H03C / Dunckley Pass 40.188105, -107.146898 2.69 mi from source footprint 2.81 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 72	H03A / Simon Reservoir Number 1 40.168428, -107.060463 1.79 mi from source footprint 1.88 mi modeled outer route 100% mapped federal land; security 66
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Departure and recovery

The things that are hard to fix after cell service ends.

PACK BEFORE DEPARTURE

- [] License, photo ID, hunter education proof if required, carcass tag intact
- [] Solid fluorescent orange/pink outer garment and visible hat
- [] Offline Hunting Atlas/ownership, Hunt Assist GPX, MVUMs, paper field packet
- [] Rifle, legal ammunition, case, eye/ear protection, zeroing targets
- [] Binoculars (do not identify bears through a rifle scope), rangefinder, headlamp
- [] Tent/sleep system; food and every scented item consolidated for locked-car storage
- [] Game bags, gloves, knife, cooling plan, cord, evidence-of-sex plan
- [] Phone power, charging adapters/cables, tire kit, compressor, recovery/traction basics
- [] Exact cash/check for remote fee sites, water, and a no-fire cooking option

CONTACTS

CPW Grand Junction / West Rifle
970-255-6100

CPW Meeker / Trappers
970-878-6090

CPW Steamboat / Chapman
970-870-3333

White River - Rifle Ranger District
970-625-2371

White River - Blanco Ranger District
970-878-4039

Tesla roadside assistance
877-798-3752

OFFICIAL SOURCES

- 2026 Colorado Big Game Brochure
<https://cpw.state.co.us/sites/default/files/dam/erjzbx48be/colorado-big-game-hunting-brochure.pdf>
- CPW Bear - In the Field
<https://cpw.state.co.us/activities/hunting/big-game/hunting-bear/bear-field>
- CPW West Rifle Creek SWA
<https://cpw.state.co.us/state-wildlife-areas/west-rifle-creek-swa>
- White River food storage order WRNF-2024-11
<https://www.fs.usda.gov/sites/nfs/files/r02/whiteriver/publication/alerts/fseprd1175796%20Food%20storage%20order.pdf>
- Flat Tops Wilderness order WRNF-2024-10
https://www.fs.usda.gov/Internet/FSE_DOCUMENTS/fseprd1164097.pdf
- Shepherds Rim campground
<https://www.recreation.gov/camping/campgrounds/234795>
- Horse Thief stock-only listing
<https://www.recreation.gov/camping/campgrounds/10352163>
- White River current alerts
<https://www.fs.usda.gov/r02/whiteriver/alerts>
- Tesla Rifle Supercharger
<https://www.tesla.com/findus/location/supercharger/32776>
- Tesla Kremmling Supercharger
<https://www.tesla.com/findus/location/supercharger/kremmlingcoparkavenuesupercharger>

Prepared September 26, 2026. Posted orders, closures, property boundaries, and the physical license control over this planning aid.